

Homework 7, Week 8

Activity 7

Identify the specific items contrasted in the following passage comparing sentimental novels and Westerns. Number in sequence each point of contrast, and underline both sides of the contrast. The first pair of contrast has been underlined as an example.

The female, domestic, “sentimental” religion of the best-selling women writers—Harriet Beecher Stowe, Susan Warner, Maria Cummins, and dozens of others—whose novels spoke to the deepest beliefs and highest ideas of middle-class America, is the real antagonist of the Western.

You can see this simply by comparing the main features of the Western with the sentimental novel. In these books... a woman is always the main character, usually a young orphan girl, with several other main characters being women too. Most of the action takes place in private spaces, at home, indoors, in kitchens, parlors, and upstairs chambers. And most of it concerns the interior struggle of the heroine to live up to an ideal of Christian virtue—usually involving uncomplaining submission to difficult and painful circumstances, learning to quell rebellious instincts, and dedicating her life to the service of God through serving others. In these struggles, women give one another a great deal of emotional and material support, and they have close relationships verging on what today we would identify as homosocial and homoerotic. There’s a great deal of Bible reading, praying, hymn singing, and drinking of tea. Emotions other than anger are expressed very freely and openly. Often there are long, drawn-out death scenes in which a saintly woman dies a natural death at home...

The elements of the typical Western plot arrange themselves in stark opposition to this pattern, not just vaguely and generally but point for point. First of all, in Westerns (which are generally written by men), the main character is always a full-grown adult male, and almost all of the other characters are men. The action takes place either outdoors—on the prairie, on the main street—or in public places—the saloon, the sheriff’s office, the barber shop, the livery stable. The action concerns physical struggles between the hero and a rival or rivals, and culminates in a fight to the death with guns. In the course of these struggles the hero frequently forms a bond with another man—sometimes his rival, more often a comrade—a bond that is more important than any relation he acts with a woman and is frequently tinged with homoeroticism. There is very little free expression of emotions. The hero is a man of few words who expresses himself through physical action—usually fighting. And when death occurs it is never at home in bed but always sudden death, usually murder.

- Main characters

- Other characters
- Background
- Main Idea
- Emotion
- Death Scene

	Sentimental Novels	Westerns
Main Characters	Young orphan girl	Full-Grown Adult male
Other characters	women too	men
Background	in private spaces	outdoors or in public places
Main Idea	Living up to the ideal of Christian Virtue; homosocial and homoerotic	Struggle with the rivals and form bond; little homoerotic
Emotion	very freely and openly	little free expression
Death Scene	natural death at home	Sudden death

Text A

Born to Be Different

Camille Lewis

1. The notion that the differences between the sexes (beyond the obvious **anatomical** ones) are biologically based is **fraught** with controversy. Such beliefs can easily be misinterpreted and used as the basis for harmful, **oppressive** stereotypes. They can be overstated and exaggerated into blanket statements about what men and women “can” and “can’t” do; about what the genders are “good” and “bad” at. And yet, the unavoidable fact is that studies are making it ever clearer that, as groups, men and women differ in almost every measurable aspect. Learning about those differences helps us understand why men and women are simultaneously so attracted and fascinated, and yet so frequently **stymied** and frustrated, by the opposite sex. ***(Introduce the topic that there actually exists dozens of differences of many aspects between men and women)***
2. To begin with, let’s look at something as basic as the anatomy of the brain. Typically, men have larger skulls and brains than women. But the sexes score equally well on intelligence tests. This apparent contradiction is explained by the fact that our brains are **apportioned**

differently. Women have about 15 percent more “gray matter” than men. Gray matter, made up of nerve cells and the branches that connect them, allows the quick transference of thought from one part of the brain to another. This high concentration of gray matter helps explain women’s ability to look at many sides of an argument at once, and to do several tasks (or hold several conversations) simultaneously. ***(Focus on the differences of physical structure of brain between men and women and emphasize the "gray matter" ability of women of concentration)***

3. Men’s brains, on the other hand, have a more generous portion of “white matter.” White matter, which is made up of neurons, actually inhibits the spread of information. It allows men to concentrate very narrowly on a specific task, without being distracted by thoughts that might conflict with the job at hand. ***(From physical structure "White matter" explains the reason why men narrowly concentrate on a specific task)***
4. Our brains’ very different makeup leads to our very different methods of interacting with the world around us. Simon Baron - Cohen, author of *The Essential Difference: Men, Women and the Extreme Male Brain*, has labeled the classic female mental process as “empathizing.” He defines empathizing as “the drive to identify another person’s emotions and thoughts, and to respond to these with an appropriate emotion.” Empathizers are constantly measuring and responding to the surrounding emotional temperature. They are concerned about showing sensitivity to the people around them. This empathetic quality can be observed in virtually all aspects of women’s lives: from the choice of typically female-dominated careers (nursing, elementary school teaching, social work) to reading matter popular mainly with women (romantic fiction, articles about relationships, advice columns about how people can get along better) to women’s interaction with one another (which typically involves intimate discussion of relationships with friends and family, and sympathy for each other’s concerns). So powerful is the empathizing mindset that it even affects how the typical female memory works. Ask a woman when a particular event happened, and she often pinpoints it in terms of an occurrence that had emotional content: “That was the summer my sister broke her leg,” or “That was around the time Gene and Mary got into such an awful argument.” Likewise, she is likely to bring her empathetic mind to bear on geography. She’ll remember a particular address not as 11th and Market Streets but being “near the restaurant where we went on our anniversary,” or “around the corner from Liz’s old apartment.” ***(State the female has the ability of empathizing which influence many aspects of their lives in careers, reading habits, conversation and geography)***
5. In contrast, Baron - Cohen calls the typical male mindset “systemizing,” which he defines as “the drive to analyze and explore a system, to extract underlying rules that govern the behavior of a system.” A systemizer is less interested in how people feel than in how things work. Again, the systematic brain influences virtually all aspects of the typical man’s life. Male - dominated professions (such as engineering, computer programming, auto repair, and mathematics) rely heavily on systems, formulas, and patterns, and very little on the ability to **intuit** another person’s thoughts or emotions. Reading material most popular with

men includes science fiction and history, as well as factual “how-to” magazines on such topics as computers, photography, home repair, and woodworking. When they get together with male friends, men are far less likely to engage in intimate conversation than they are to share an activity: watching or playing sports, working on a car, bowling, golfing, or fishing. Men’s conversation is **peppered** with dates and addresses, illustrating their comfort with systems: “Back in 1996 when I was living in Boston...,” or “The best way to the new stadium is to go all the way out Walnut Street to 33rd and then get on the bypass...” **(State the male has the ability of systemizing which influence many aspects of their lives which is the same as former and form a contrast with female)**

6. One final way that men and women differ is in their typical responses to problem-solving. Ironically, it may be this very activity—intended on both sides to eliminate problems—that creates the most conflict between partners of the opposite sex. To a woman, the process of solving a problem is all-important. Talking about a problem is a means of deepening the intimacy between her and her partner. The very anatomy of her brain, as well as her accompanying empathetic mindset, makes her want to consider all sides of a question and to explore various possible solutions. To have a partner who is willing to explore a problem with her is deeply satisfying. She interprets that willingness as an expression of the other’s love and concern. **(Interpret the methods of female's problem-solving which is all important and consider all sides of a question)**
 7. But men have an almost completely opposite approach when it comes to dealing with a problem. Everything in their mental makeup tells them to focus narrowly on the issue, solve it, and get it out of the way. The ability to fix a problem quickly and efficiently is, to them, a demonstration of their power and competence. When a man hears his female partner begin to describe a problem, his strongest impulse is to listen briefly and then tell her what to do about it. From his perspective, he has made a helpful and loving gesture; from hers, he’s short-circuited a conversation that could have deepened and strengthened their relationship. **(State the methods of male's problem-solving which is focus on quickly solving the problems)**
 8. The challenge that confronts men and women is to put aside ideas of “better” and “worse” when it comes to their many differences. Our diverse brain development, our ways of interacting with the world, and our modes of dealing with problems all have their strong points. In some circumstances, a typically **feminine** approach may be more effective; in others, a classically **masculine** mode may have the advantage. Our differences aren’t going to disappear: My daughter, now a middle-schooler, regularly tells me she loves me, while her teenage brothers express their affection by grabbing me in a **headlock**. Learning to understand and appreciate one another’s gender-specific qualities is the key to more rich and rewarding lives together. **(Call for confronting and understanding the differences between men and women rather than argue for which one is better)**
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Significant Words and Phrases

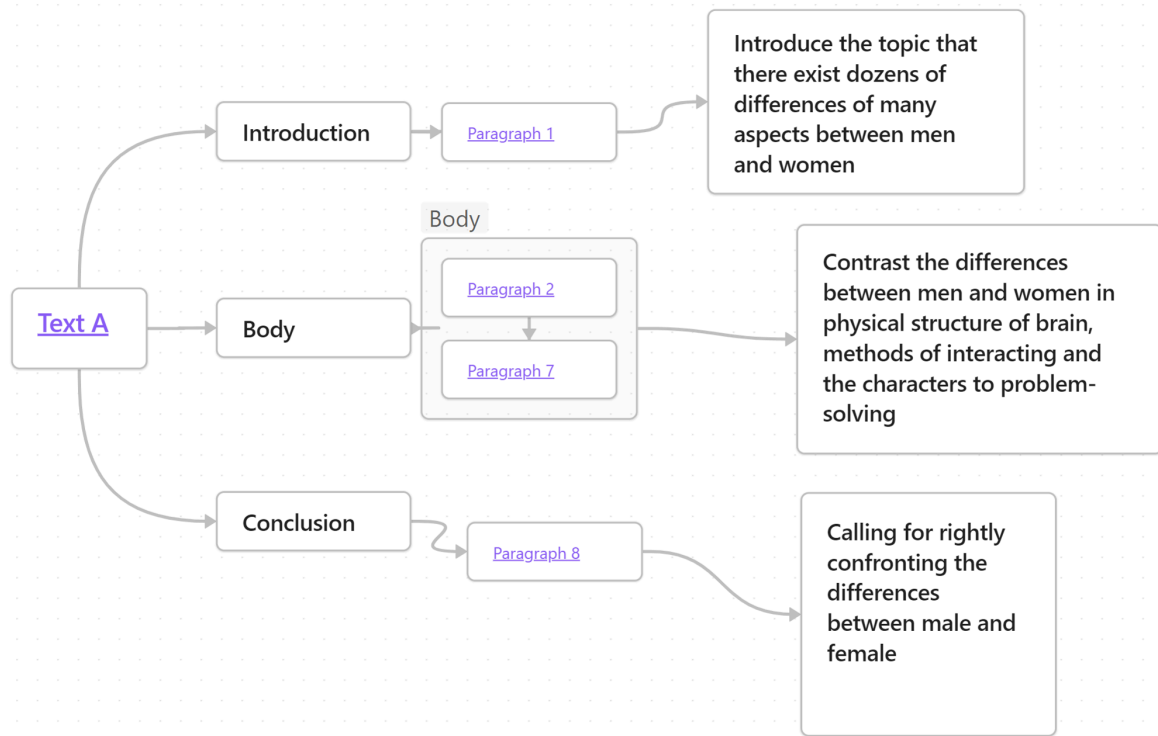
- anatomical
relating to the structure of body
 - fraught
filled with
 - oppressive #CET6
unjust; weighing heavily
 - stymie
obstruct
 - apportion
distribute
 - intuit
know by intuition
 - pepper #CET4 #CET6
filled
 - feminine #CET6
the characters that female has
 - masculine #CET6
the characters that male has
 - headlock
lock the head
-

Topic Idea

This essay from the physical structure of brain, methods of interacting and the characters to problem-solving states the differences between male and female and calls for rightly confronting the differences.

Structure

Structure of Text A



Activity 2

Task I

Task 1 Think critically about the writing techniques used in Text A and discuss the following questions in groups.

1. Many expository essays make explicit thesis statements in their introductory paragraphs. Is there a thesis statement in this essay's introduction? If yes, what is the thesis statement?
2. In a comparison and contrast essay, the writer often has to shift from one subject to another and from one point of comparison to another. Effective transition is therefore needed to guide the readers through such constant shift of focus. Identify transitional words or sentences that help Lewis move from one gender difference to another. Then locate transitional words or sentences that shift the discussion from women to men. Are they effective? Why or why not?
3. In Paragraphs 4 and 5, Lewis uses some imaginary examples to support her argument about a gender-specific mindset. Are these examples convincing? Why or why not?
4. Comment on the effectiveness of the essay's conclusion by considering the following questions: 1) How does it summarize the major points of comparison and contrast? 2) How does it go beyond a plain statement of differences to make a meaningful point? 3) What's the purpose of the personal anecdote? 4) How does it echo the opening paragraph?
5. What effect does Lewis expect her essay to have on her readers? Is she successful in affecting you in such a way? Explain.

1. Yes. The thesis statement is the first sentence in the first paragraph.
2. In paragraph 3, "on the other hand";
In paragraph 5, "In contrast";
In paragraph 7, "but";
They are all effective to shift the discussion from women to men since they explicitly tell the readers that the author has shift the objects and can grabber readers' mind.
3. They are very convincing because they are processed by the actual life and can behalf of the aspect as a typical example.
4. It summarizes the major points by directly show the topic sentence when stating the female and directly show the shift of discussion.
It divides the two genders into two paragraph which make the author can more in detail state the differences. It also take many examples to make the statement more convincing. Personal anecdote can make the essay more funny and can make the readers immerse in the scene so that make the essay more convincing.
In the last paragraph the author states the challenges between men and women again that echo the opening paragraph.

5. She want us to rightly confront the differences between men and women rather than argue for which one is better. As for me, she is successful in affecting me because I deeply understand the reasons why men and women are different from the article.

Task II

Task 2 Use key words and phrases to fill in the outline of Paragraphs 4 and 5. Notice how the various points of contrast in Paragraph 5 are presented in the same order as in Paragraph 4.

Points to be compared: female and male mindsets

	Para. 4 (Women)	Para. 5 (Men)
Baron-Cohen's definition		
Overall quality		
Examples	Job: _____	Job: _____
	Reading: _____	Reading: _____
	Communication: _____	Communication: _____
	Memory: _____	Memory: _____

	Para.4(Women)	Para.5(Men)
Baron-Cohen's definition	emphathizing	systemizing
Overall quality	Women can better identify person's emotions and thoughts	Men can better analyze and explore a system
Examples	Job: female-dominated careers such as nursing, elementary schooling teaching, social works. Reading: Romantic fiction, articles about relationships and so on. Communication: Intimate discussion	Job: male-dominated careers such as engineering, computer programming and mathematics. Reading: Science fiction and history, magazines with interested topics and so on. Communication:

	Para.4(Women)	Para.5(Men)
	Memory: State the address or date by saying another things	Share an activity rather than intimate discussion Memory: State accurate address and date

The Two Americas

J. William Fulbright

1. There are two Americas. One is the America of Lincoln; the other is the America of Teddy Roosevelt and the modern **superpatriots**. One is generous and **humane**, the other narrowly **egotistical**; one is self-critical, the other self-righteous; one is sensible, the other romantic; one is good-humored, the other **solemn**; one is inquiring, the other **pontificating**, one is moderate, the other filled with passionate intensity; one is **judicious** and the other **arrogant** in the use of great power. ***(State the topic of two Americas and contrast the differences between them)***
2. We have tended in the years of our great power to puzzle the world by presenting to it now the one face of America, now the other, and sometimes both at once. Many people all over the world have come to regard America as being capable of magnanimity and farsightedness but no less capable of **pettiness** and spite. The result is an inability to anticipate American actions which in turn makes for **apprehension** and a lack of confidence in American aims. ***(Show the transformation of the image the world to America and its positive influence)***
3. The inconsistency of American foreign policy is not an accident but an expression of two distinct sides of the American character. Both are characterized by a kind of moralism, but one is the morality of decent instincts tempered by the knowledge of human imperfection and the other is the morality of absolute self-assurance fired by the **crusading** spirit. The one is exemplified by Lincoln, who found it strange in the words of his second **Inaugural** Address, "that any man should dare to ask for a just God's assistance in **wringing** their bread from the sweat of other men's faces," but then added: "Let us judge not, that we be not judged." The other is exemplified by Theodore Roosevelt, who in his December 6, 1904, Annual Message to Congress, without question or doubt as to his own and his country's capacity to judge right and wrong, proclaimed the duty of the United States to exercise an "internal police power" in the hemisphere on the ground that "**chronic** wrong-doing, or an **impotence** which results in general loosening of the ties of civilized society, may in America...ultimately require intervention by some civilized nation..."Roosevelt of course never questioned that the "wrongdoing" would be done by our Latin neighbors and we of

course were the “civilized nation” with the duty to set things right. (**Show the differences in spirit and exemplification**)

4. After twenty-five years of world power the United States must decide which of the two sides of its national character is to predominate--- the humanism of Lincoln or the arrogance of those who would make America the world's policeman. One or the other will help shape the spirit of the age---unless of course we refuse to choose, in which America may come to play a less important role in the world, leaving the great decisions to others. (**Outlook the future if one of the two Americas come to power**)
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Significant Words and Phrases

- superpatriot
persons who extremely love the country
- humane #CET6
concerning about humanity
- egotistical
only considering himself or herself
- solemn #CET4 #CET6
serious
- pontificating
discussing without considering others' thoughts
- judicious
intelligent
- arrogant #CET6
showing the feelings that overbear pride
- pettiness
narrowness
- apprehension
worry
- crusade
a series of actions advancing a principle or tending toward a particular end
- inaugural
the introduction into a position
- wringing
a twisting squeeze
- chronic #CET6
being long-lasting

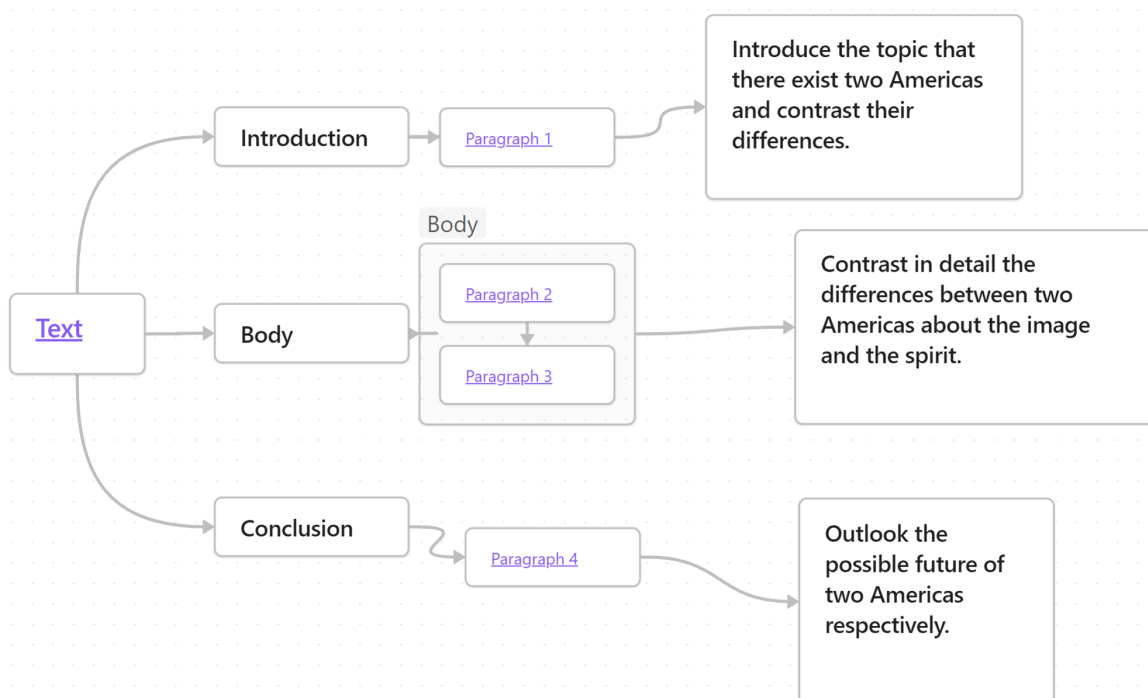
- impotence
being weak

Topic Idea

This article contrasts the differences between two different Americas, states in detail about the image and spirit and finally outlook the future of two Americas.

Structure

Structure of Text



Listening Task

2024 年 12 月大学英语四级考试真题（第 2 套）

Part I

Writing

(30 minutes)

Directions: Suppose the university newspaper is inviting submissions from the students for its coming edition on how to enrich students' knowledge of traditional Chinese culture. You are now to write an essay for submission. You will have 30 minutes to write the essay. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

Part II

Listening Comprehension

(25 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard.

1. A) They will see a 27% higher price to buy natural gas.
B) They will have insufficient heating oil to keep warm.
C) They will have a costly bill to pay to heat their homes.
D) They will experience the coldest winter in four decades.
2. A) Provided additional funding to Low Income Home Energy Assistance Program.
B) Assured U.S. citizens of an increase in energy supplies by the end of this year.
C) Predicted a 10% jump in heating bills for most U.S. households this winter.
D) Decided on this year's energy assistance package of \$8 billion in total.

Questions 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.

3. A) They care less about their diet now than before.
B) They may lack adequate knowledge of healthy food.
C) They may hold too optimistic a view about their diet.
D) They pay insufficient attention to their choice of food.
4. A) Those who finished 24-hour food questionnaires.
B) Those who fully understood the rating scale.
C) Those who cared about food quality.
D) Those who rated their diet as poor.

1. us. family. winter
energy. up
reduce 28%
have half
add. 27%
keep warm.

bill 300
8bi D. 1.5 A. 0.5

C

2. A

3. American head food
search.

do. excellent grade.

rating

C

4. B. D

5. moment Indian

6. B 7. A.

8. M.

online.

safe.

too much.

half price.

bank

spend more.

B

9. D

10. D A

11. D B

12. m

w

future

soccer.

ben

team.

basketball.

cooperata.

volleyball.

gender.

elephant. fell
well. food.

A.B

.D.25

indoor.

different. A C

13.D

14. R C

15. D A

16. harmful

around gas

space. 2020

10 p/r/y.

liquid.

sustainable

waste

expendable

renew.

~~CB~~

committing

17. D

18. A

19. child.

reading

aloud

confident.

secure. communi

respons

pets food

de learning.

work freshen.

ben friend.

~~A~~ B

20. A 21. D

22. package
bill. under way

with payment.

perspective.

oppo

ten

get competitive.

~~B~~ A

23. D

24. B

25. C

negging .

indepen .

A D C 12 D A

D. d